Avelumab — metastatic Merkel-cell carcinoma

NCCP 00535 · Draft source reconciliation; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Taking or receiving treatment

Avelumab 800 mg is infused over 60 minutes. An antihistamine and paracetamol are given before the first four infusions; NCCP specifies at least 30 minutes beforehand. After that, premedication is at consultant discretion if no reaction occurred. Allow additional time for checks, preparation and observation.

STEP 2

Missed, vomited or held treatment

Contact the unit if a visit is missed or treatment is held. A new appointment and any changed premedication or infusion plan must be confirmed by the team. A severe infusion or immune reaction can change whether treatment is restarted at all.

STEP 3

Appointments and supply

Arrange blood tests, transport, medicine supply and interpreter or carer support. Check who reviews results and how you receive the decision before the next dose.

STEP 4

Paper copies and contacts

Keep the full handbook, three-page summary and wallet card together. The QR code is optional. Ask the team to replace every labelled example contact with your real oncology and out-of-hours details; ask for a new printed plan when treatment changes.

Sources: NCCP 00535 v7: current regimen source. Draft source reconciliation; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.